paid, together with a declaration from such persons that they do not have a bank account. The list should indicate the purpose for which the proposed payments are being made.'

Banks were instructed to 'keep a proper record of the evidence and produce them for verification by the authorities in case of need', making stressed bankers, who were already drowning in extra paper work, throw up their hands in despair. Facing enormous criticism, RBI diluted the norms slightly the next day, and declarations were only required for cash payments of more than ₹10,000 to a single person.

The deaths of three distraught fathers were attributed to the demonetization. Sukhdev Singh of Punjab died of a heart attack as no one was accepting the money he had saved for his daughter's marriage.[47] Jagdish Pawar of Rajasthan too died of a heart attack, stressed over not having enough cash for his daughter's wedding. Suresh Sonar of Uttar Pradesh died from the same reason after failing to exchange currency notes for the money needed for his daughter's Tilak ceremony.[48] As a distraught parent said, 'We have been running around for three days trying to prove to bank officers that our daughter is genuinely getting married! We have saved all our lives for this day and now we cannot get our own money to pay for our child's wedding.'[49]

The final straw was the RBI notification[50] on 19 December stating that customers could henceforth only deposit amounts in excess of ₹5,000 once during the remaining period till 30 December 2016, adding, 'The credit in such cases shall be afforded *only after questioning tenderer, on record, in the presence of at least two officials of the bank*, as to why this could not be deposited earlier and receiving a satisfactory explanation. The explanation should be kept on record to facilitate an audit trail at a later stage. An appropriate flag also should be raised in CBS (the Central Banking System) to that effect so that no more tenders are allowed.'

Vexed bankers and irritated customers vented their spleen, and social media was filled with caustic jokes. WhatsApp messages went